Waipapa Taumata Rau
University of Auckland

Part IV Project #123
Department of Electrical, Computer, and Software Engineering

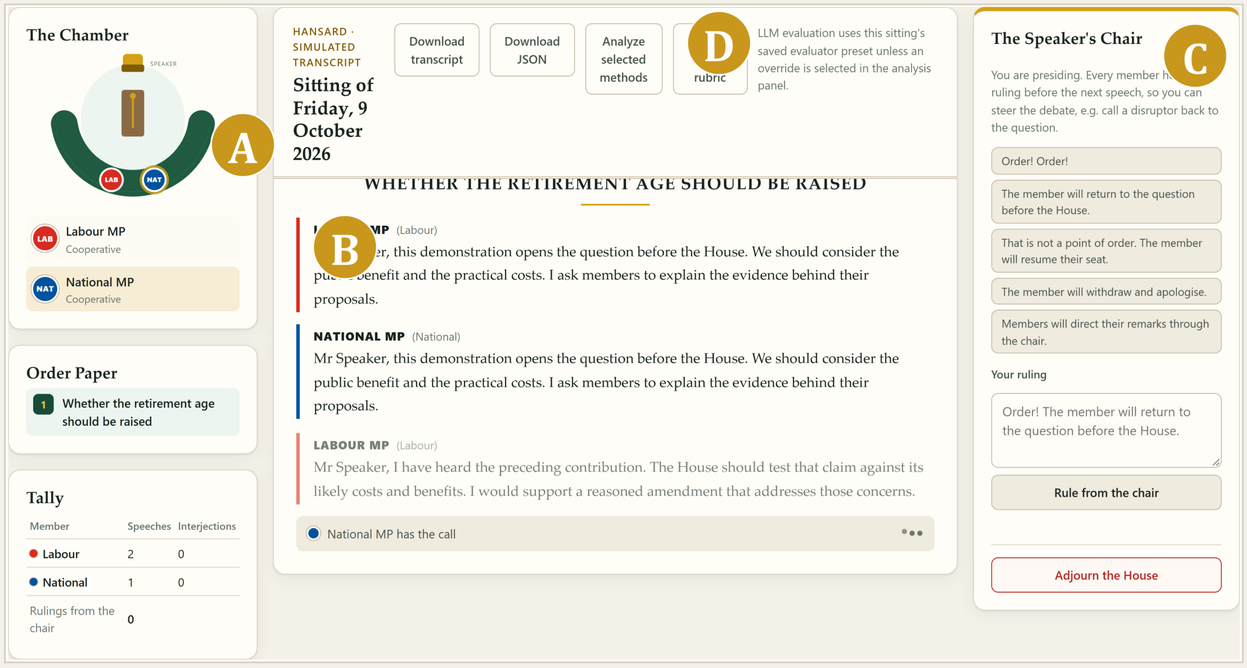
AI-Based Virtual Parliament

Does more Hansard grounding improve AI debate?

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We built a virtual New Zealand Parliament to study how language models debate. We tested whether more Hansard excerpts, drawn from real parliamentary speeches, improve debate quality.

1 One platform, three interfaces



A Chamber and party agents

Watch who has the floor and each party's role.

B Live and saved Hansard

Speeches stream to a transcript that can be reopened after restart.

C The Speaker's Chair

Rulings reach every agent before the next speech.

D Exports and evaluation

Download JSON/text and run local analysis or the separate LLM rubric.

Fig. 1 Updated browser (deterministic demo). Browser, guided CLI and commands share one backend.

2 Private agents, reproducible debates

Real Hansard	Private setup	Five AI MPs	Debate engine	Saved evidence
500 reviewed excerpts 100 per party [1]	Own persona, excerpts and optional tactic	Own setup + public debate evidence	Turns, topics, reply cues and rulings	Public transcript + separate evaluations

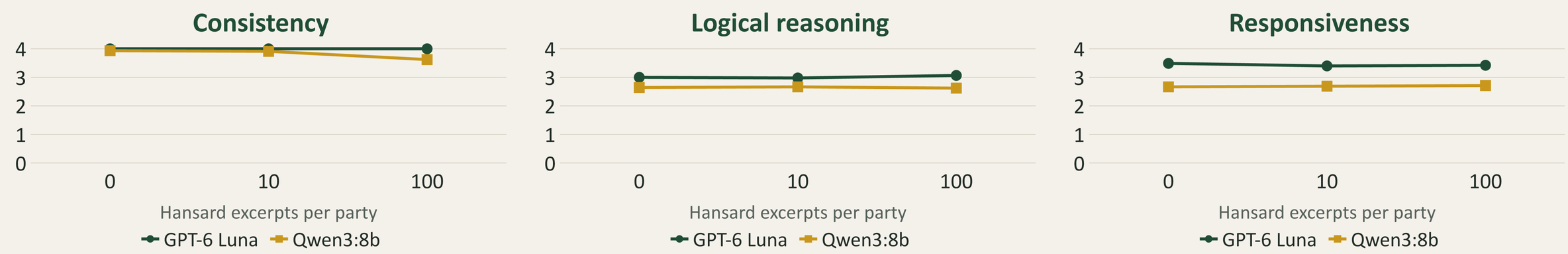
Independent debate and judge models, including Ollama. Captured prompts and settings preserve each run.

Five separate rubric metrics plus local sentiment and stance. Private setup stays out of public exports.

3 More grounding gave no consistent gain

2 models × 3 topics × 3 grounding levels × 3 repetitions = 54 debates, 1,350 speeches [2]

Five parties, five rounds. Retirement age, nuclear power and the four-day workweek. No adversarial tactics or interruptions.



Qwen consistency: 3.93 at 0 excerpts, 3.62 at 100 (-0.31 points). Other changes were small or mixed.

Relevance endpoints were unchanged (Luna 4.00, Qwen 3.98). Disruptive rhetoric averaged 0.00-0.04.

Nine debates per model/level, 45 party scores per metric. Common GPT-6 Luna judge. Higher rhetoric means more disruption.

Exploratory automated scores without human validation. These baseline runs do not test adversarial robustness.

4 Outcomes and next steps

Outcome

A reproducible debate platform. Extra Hansard showed no consistent gain in rubric scores.

Next work

Test adversarial tactics. Add human review, more topics and more repetitions.

Contributions

Albert Sun: frontend and live chamber.
Kieran Joe: architecture and MP agents.

References

[1] Rauh & Schwalbach (2020). ParlSpeech V2.
[2] Project 123 debate evaluation study, October 2026.

Acknowledgements

Political science collaborators, Georgetown University.
Members are AI archetypes, not real MPs.

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